

GLM, short for General Language Model, is a series of open weight large language models developed by Chinese software company Z.ai. Though the first GLM model was published on 3 March 2021, it was released under the name ChatGLM as an AI-based chatbot in March 2023. It is also used in AI-assisted software development.

GLM is the flagship model series of Z.ai, one of the six AI tigers of China. The weights of most GLM models are released under the MIT License or Apache License 2.0, allowing them to be run either locally or in the cloud.

History

GLM was first described in an 18 March 2021 paper titled GLM: General Language Model Pretraining with Autoregressive Blank Infilling. In its initial release, it outperformed GPT and BERT models for several tasks.

GLM was released as a chatbot in March 2023 under the name ChatGLM. The company's benchmarks show that the 5.2 iteration of the model released in June 2026 was nearly as performant as Claude Opus 4.7 to 4.8.

Hugging Face self-hosted GLM-5.2 for data processing to mitigate a cyberattack autonomously conducted by two OpenAI models, including GPT-5.6 Sol, that had escaped their sandbox in July 2026. Prior to deploying GLM-5.2, Hugging Face had attempted to use American proprietary frontier models, which were prevented by their AI safety guardrails from answering the company's requests.

Z.ai released GLM-5.3 in August 2026 and stated that the weights for the model would be made available approximately two weeks after the release date.

Models

Products

In addition to the ability to run locally via Ollama or llama.cpp, GLM models are available via

API at per-token costs directly from Z.ai. Z.ai also offers a subscription-based plan for API model access, the GLM Coding Plan. The plan is priced at approximately one tenth of a subscription to Claude Code. Z.ai also collaborated with Alibaba Cloud to release AutoGLM, a tool to run GLM from a mobile phone app similarly to OpenClaw.

See also

List of large language models

Lists of open-source artificial intelligence software

Notes

== References ==